

Kilimo Bridge — Farmer Import File Guide

For cooperative administrators preparing member lists

Version 1.0 · July 2026

Overview

This guide explains how to prepare Excel or CSV files for importing farmers into Kilimo Bridge. Following these rules minimises errors and ensures every member can receive a profile and login.

File format

Accepted	Notes
Excel (.xlsx)	Preferred — upload the original workbook
CSV (.csv)	Export from Excel: File → Save As → CSV (Comma delimited)

- **One cooperative per file**
- Name the file after the cooperative (e.g. LE0ART MACADAMIA FARMERS ASSOCIATION KENYA 2026.xlsx)
- If there is no “Membership Group” column, the system uses the **file name** as the cooperative name

Required columns

Every row must have a **Name** and a **Phone** number.

Name

Accepted column headers: Name, Farmer Name, Full Name, Name of Farmer

Rule	Example
Letters, spaces, hyphens, apostrophes only	John Kamau ✓
Minimum 2 characters	Mary Wanjiku ✓
No numbers or symbols	John2 ✗, Mary & Sons ✗

Phone

Accepted column headers: Phone, Mobile, Mobile No, Contact, Tel, Telephone

Rule	Example
One unique number per farmer	No duplicates in file or system
Kenya format: 07 + 9 digits	0712345678 ✓
Or international: +254 + 9 digits	+254712345678 ✓

Format column as Text in Excel	Stops Excel removing the leading 0
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Avoid	Why
712345678	Missing leading 0
07123456789	Too many digits
Same number on two rows	Treated as duplicate
Landline / incomplete numbers	Cannot be used for OTP login

Recommended columns

Column	Header names	Example
District	District, County	Kirinyaga
Sub-County	Sub-County, Sub County	Kirinyaga Central
Gender	Gender, Sex	M, F, Male, Female
ID Number	ID Number, National ID	(blank is OK — auto-filled)

If Gender is blank, the system sets **Other**.

If ID Number is blank, the system sets **PENDING-....**

Optional columns

Country, Parish, Village, Membership Group, Occupation, Project 1, Project 2, Project 3

File layout example

Row 1: LE0ART MACADAMIA FARMERS ASSOCIATION KENYA 2026 (optional title)
 Row 2: (blank)
 Row 3: Name | Phone | District | Sub-County | Gender (header row)
 Row 4+: farmer data...

- Remove completely blank rows in the middle of the data
- Do not repeat header rows
- Delete empty rows at the bottom of the sheet

Minimum viable file

Three columns are enough if the file is named after the cooperative:

Name	Phone	District
Karanja Njiiri	0723875429	Kirinyaga

Charles Njagi	0712345678	Kirinyaga
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Before you upload — checklist

1. ☐ Every farmer has a **unique** phone number
2. ☐ All phones are `07.....` or `+254.....` format
3. ☐ Names contain **letters only** (no numbers or & symbols)
4. ☐ Phone column formatted as **Text** in Excel
5. ☐ File saved as `.xlsx` or CSV (Comma delimited)
6. ☐ File name matches the cooperative name

Import results explained

Status	Meaning
Valid	Will be imported — profile + login created
Duplicate	Phone already in system — skipped (not an error)
Invalid	Fix in Excel using the error report, then re-upload

After validation, download the **errors CSV** to see every row that needs fixing. Use the **Row** column to find the line in your spreadsheet.

Support

For Kilimo Bridge technical support, contact your platform administrator.

Kilimo Bridge — connecting farmers, cooperatives, and markets